Name: RISK 3.2 - pollution of info system; loss of consensus on reality

<Files\\Processed x Highly relevant\\2024-05-16 - STF - Tova podcast- I would never gi> - § 2 references coded [5.21% Coverage]

Reference 1 - 1.76% Coverage

TikTokâ€™s algorithm makes it unique because you donâ€™t make deliberate choices about the content youâ€™re seeing. The algorithm is powered by AI and creates hyper-personalised collections of endless, scrollable videos based on what youâ€™ve liked, shared, rewatched or stopped watching.

Reference 2 - 3.45% Coverage

She explains that researchers who created fictional accounts pretending to be 13-year-olds and then watched what happened with their feeds over 30 minutes, found that within 2.6 minutes - about 150 seconds - those â€˜13-year-oldsâ€™ were being shown suicidal content and a lot about eating disorders and mental health. They were being shown this content every 39 seconds.
â€œSo very quickly, it sends kids to these videos that romanticise and encourage self-harm and depressive thinking, and thereâ€™s also just some really depraved content on there,â€ says Marsh.

<Files\\Processed x Highly relevant\\2024-06-20 - RNZ - New AI video tech- It brings a> - § 4 references coded [22.74% Coverage]

Reference 1 - 1.17% Coverage

A breakthrough AI tool that can make fake videos has experts worried about a new generation of misinformation.

Reference 2 - 3.12% Coverage

"The issue is [the AI] keeps getting better, politically you could do anything... Chris Luxon's face is incredibly out there in the public, there's videos of him speaking and doing things," she said. "You could make him do anything with AI, and that's pretty dangerous for a political figure."

Reference 3 - 6.02% Coverage

He said the technology had come a long way in recent years.
"It wasn't so long ago we were looking at really weird looking videos, really unrealistic scenes, whereas now its increasingly challenging to spot something that's AI generated," Dr Lensen said. But he feared it could be dangerous.
"Disinformation or misinformation... especially on social media where we already see echo chambers and a lot of fake news, that sort of attack on information [brings] massive challenges in what we trust as a society," he said. "It brings a lot of things into question."

Reference 4 - 12.42% Coverage

"They could generate videos from warzones, images of natural disasters... all sorts of things could happen." As misinformation continued to dominate social media, Clark said it had become more difficult to trust the truth. "The more of these AI-generated videos we have out there the harder it's going to be to tell what is real and what is false," he said.
"So I think another risk is we're going to have real photos and videos being accused of being AI-generated, which is another form of disinformation." Dr Lensen said there were some benefits to

the groundbreaking technology, but he thought the cons outweighed the pros.
"Some people talk about things like historical reanimations... potential medical applications around visualising cancers and so on," he explained.
"But a lot of these positive applications, I think, are a bit further off whereas the negative consequences are a lot more obvious and immediate."
He said it was vital for New Zealanders to have a healthy amount of scepticism online.
"Being sceptical of everything you read and everything you see is an increasingly important skill, and that's going to become even more important."

<Files\\Processed x Highly relevant\\2024-06-25 - RNZ - 99 percent of terrorist materi> - § 1 reference coded [18.64% Coverage]

Reference 1 - 18.64% Coverage

Meta aimed to reduce but not always remove other harmful content, such as misinformation.
"We'd lower their distribution to make sure that fewer people are seeing it and it's not widely being shared or going viral. And we inform - we give people context so that they can decide what they can read and trust to share.
"Without just taking the content out, we actually tell them that this is false so that they can identify that information, they can inform themselves, and they can stay educated about what kind of misinformation you're seeing out there." The conference The Future of Facts is looking at the threat of artificial intelligence, disinformation and falling levels of trust in media. Meta was taking steps on how to alert users that content was produced by AI, Gummi said.
"We rely on people self-disclosing and making sure that they tell us that this is something that's generated with AI, or we are also working on developing industry-wide standards to identify AI-generated content and making sure people disclose that themselves."
Meta was halting its Crowd Tangle analytics tool from August, but has faced criticism for the decision because of fears it will reduce transparency and the ability to track viral content, misinformation and disinformation.

<Files\\Processed x Highly relevant\\2024-07-08 - SPN - Fake news, AI slop and little> - § 2 references coded [2.13% Coverage]

Reference 1 - 1.05% Coverage

If community building, people power and closeness come from bonding over an infinite number of AI-generated images of airline hostesses posing with Jesus, soft porn versions of women in the army, legless soldiers and trucks full of babies, then Facebook is on track. If the company has something more authentic and human in mind, it’s failing miserably.
T

Reference 2 - 1.08% Coverage

Controlled by an algorithm that is utterly opaque and dominated by either advertising or content the algorithm deems engaging, the number of recommended posts in your newsfeed (posts from pages, groups or people you don’t follow) has doubled since 2022. According to the researchers, Facebook is also actively recommending AI content, or slop, into users’ feeds.
W

<Files\\Processed x Highly relevant\\2024-08-01 - RNZ - Can only damage trust - NZME u> - § 2 references coded [6.80% Coverage]

Reference 1 - 2.40% Coverage

Media publisher NZME has come under fire for admitting it used artificial intelligence to create editorials that ran in the Weekend Herald and other publications, with a media commentator saying it "can only damage trust".

Reference 2 - 4.40% Coverage

"When the public hears that AI is being used in places - and perhaps most importantly here is that it wasn't acknowledged that was being used to create this editorial - then that can only damage trust.
"I think there's a lot of issues here including that AI can be incredibly useful for data analysis and other things in journalism, but we just have to be incredibly transparent about how we're using it."

<Files\\Processed x Highly relevant\\2024-08-02 - RNZ - NZME calls all-staff meeting a> - § 1 reference coded [5.75% Coverage]

Reference 1 - 5.75% Coverage

The media publisher has come under fire for admitting it used AI to create editorials that ran in the Weekend Herald and other publications, with a media commentator saying it "can only damage trust".

<Files\\Processed x Highly relevant\\2024-08-04 - RNZ - AI editorial puts spotlight on> - § 7 references coded [9.12% Coverage]

Reference 1 - 3.88% Coverage

"Across all of the countries, only around 1/3 of the respondents say that they feel comfortable using news made mostly by humans with the help of AI. So 36 percent and the proportion is even smaller, so just around one in five when it comes to news that's made mostly by AI with some human oversight," said lead researcher Dr Amy Ross Aguedes.
She also said that media companies have to be careful alerting people to their use of AI, because it draws attention to something that they find confusing - even alarming. "Going overboard with labeling or using language that's really vague carries the risk of scaring off people who already tend to have low levels of trust in news and lower levels of knowledge about AI. They're going to tend to default to more negative assumptions," she said. "But at the same time, failing to provide audiences with information that they may want to decide what news they want to use - and what news they trust - could also prove damaging. Publishers are going to have to thread this needle very carefully," she said.

Reference 2 - 0.86% Coverage

"The risks are much higher now because you can create such exceptional images. It's really important . . . to be on guard with this and as transparent as possible." "The news media industry have enough trouble with trust already." I

Reference 3 - 1.40% Coverage

The front page of the June edition was hotly debated on the online forum Reddit after one user discovered a stock library selling the same image slugged 'happy builder wearing a helmet and reflective vest.'
A note attached says: "Generated with AI. Editorial use must not be misleading or deceptive."
But there was no such declaration for readers of the June issue of Tradie.

Reference 4 - 0.85% Coverage

Kaleb Francis, a digital strategist at the Auckland based marketing agency Marque argued (https://www.marque.co.nz/blog/ai-generated-images-brand-transparency) the media are risking their reputation by using AI images in this way.

Reference 5 - 0.63% Coverage

"How do we trust that what is being shared is actually true?" "Step by step, [AI] is going to get more and more convincing. People won't know what is real and what is not.

Reference 6 - 0.79% Coverage

"If this is the voice of the paper, but it's actually being generated by AI... who's the voice? Where's it coming from? I am paying for it - but for AI to write it? That just doesn't seem like the value exchange."

Reference 7 - 0.72% Coverage

"Why wouldn't I want to know? The media inform people and keep them up to date and let them know what is real. So if they expect it, but the media is not delivering it... then how would you feel?"

<Files\\Processed x Highly relevant\\2024-08-24 - RNZ - Why internet searches are serv> - § 5 references coded [19.41% Coverage]

Reference 1 - 0.85% Coverage

Meanwhile, so-called "AI slop" is coursing through the internet all over the place - unwanted, unloved and perhaps even unstoppable.

Reference 2 - 5.57% Coverage

Danyl McLauchlan, author and IT systems consultant at Victoria University of Wellington's School of Biological Sciences, said science fiction has foretold what happens when such content is left to spread unchecked.
"Neal Stephenson... describes nations in the future as having been 'Facebooked', which is... that kind of phenomenon of being completely swamped by meaningless gibberish," he told RNZ's Saturday Morning.
Stephenson coined the phrase 'metaverse' in 1992's Snow Crash, which directly inspired the name of Facebook's parent company, Meta - which has poured billions of dollars into creating the kind of virtual reality Stephenson wrote about in his dystopic novel. Facebook has in the past been accused of creating algorithmic 'echo chambers', in which people are served up engaging content which might differ completely from what others are seeing.

Reference 3 - 2.44% Coverage

"There is no coherent media or what he calls 'consensual reality'," McLauchlan said. "No one agrees on what basically is happening in the country because everyone is getting different algorithmically sort of news feeds.
"And so the nation collapses, because you do need that kind of consensual reality to even argue meaningfully about what's going on and what should happen."

Reference 4 - 5.49% Coverage

"It's my favourite short story, so I'm really happy that people are now being terrified by it. But it describes a universe that is just one vast library and every book that can possibly be written is in this library.
"And so in theory the answers to all of the meaningful questions in life are hidden in the library somewhere. But because the vast majority of books that could possibly be written just contain strings of, you know, of alphanumeric characters that have no relation to each other, they're just filled with gibberish.
"You would need to sort of like you know, cross trillions of human lifetimes just reading through the books over and over again to find a single coherent sentence, let alone anything meaningful and true. And so that is the comparison that's often made to the torrents of AI slop that are taking over the internet."

Reference 5 - 5.06% Coverage

"I was looking at celebrities - Donald Trump, Joe Rogan - and on TikTok and Instagram, you'll find these so-called 'stories' and they have they have deepfake voices of these people saying things. And you know, we've all been primed to think, 'Oh, the Russians are creating this, you know, deep fake technology to destroy our democracy.' But actually, it's not political content, it's not even content. It's just random gibberish in the voices of these celebrities. "And so what they're doing is they're creating vast volumes of this content as a form of search engine optimisation. So, whenever anything searches anything, you'll increasingly get AI slop... you can use these open-source models and just spin up a instance on a cloud computer and generate gigantic volumes of garbage."

<Files\\Processed x Highly relevant\\2024-08-25 - NZH - War of the AI bots> - § 5 references coded [11.34% Coverage]

Reference 1 - 1.55% Coverage

The bots were not necessarily aiming to present one point of view but instead to amplify division, sow distrust in institutions, and make it less possible to debate ideas in the public square.

Reference 2 - 1.65% Coverage

â€œEven if they donâ€™t change hearts and minds they are absolutely creating a less trustworthy information environment. Theyâ€™re creating, perhaps, more cynicism about the integrity of our public debate.

Reference 3 - 1.97% Coverage

Disinformation network research director Sanjana Hattotuwa said the AI network should be seen as a â€œharbinger of whatâ€™s comingâ€ and said it also highlighted the role social media networks had in allowing the amplification of disinformation.

Reference 4 - 2.14% Coverage

Mansted said one factor making such disinformation initiatives more powerful was fewer â€œgatekeepers of truthâ€ in the media now. She said social media platforms, which people turned to as news sources, were unwilling to actively take down disinformation networks.

Reference 5 - 4.03% Coverage

She added the network could have a much larger impact later on as only â€œone-30thâ€ of accounts associated with it were currently active. Mansted said this demonstrated a â€œnascent capability for information warfareâ€ .
â€œItâ€™s less about what [AI] has done and more about what it could do, and as New Zealand politics changes, as New Zealandâ€™s relations with other countries change, I think thatâ€™s where we might see this network or indeed others pivot and potentially try and interfere.â€

<Files\\Processed x Highly relevant\\2024-09-30 - RNZ - Is New Zealand ready for AI-ge> - § 1 reference coded [3.67% Coverage]

Reference 1 - 3.67% Coverage

"The US is much further ahead than us. The US has actually codified personality rights, so a person has very clear rights to their image and the representation." Kalupahana said there was also no requirement to declare whether something is AI-generated.

<Files\\Processed x Highly relevant\\2025-01-15 - NZH - From 3G shutdown to AI slop- T> - § 2 references coded [6.65% Coverage]

Reference 1 - 2.75% Coverage

2025â€™s worst AI trend so far is AI slop: AI-generated email and LinkedIn replies that add nothing to a conversation; technologically wonderous but pointless tools that allow a still image to be turned into four seconds of video, the better to clog up everyoneâ€™s social media feeds, and tools that make it easy for anyone to create a fake video â€" making it impossible to know what LA firefighting or newgadget stills or video in your social feeds are real or fake.

Reference 2 - 3.90% Coverage

â€œWe expect these AIs to actually, over time, exist on our platforms, kind of in the same way that accounts do,â€ Hayes told the paper.
Thereâ€™s been speculation by pundits that Meta could use AI-generated users to push products as fake â€œinfluencersâ€ or to just make make its users feel better by padding their likes, comments and follower counts with artificial profiles and AI-generated content.
Thereâ€™s also potential for the madness of content generated by AI profiles being read and responded to by other AIs â€" boosting activity and engagement stats, even if not those involving the carbon-based lifeforms that advertisers actually want to reach.

<Files\\Processed x Highly relevant\\2025-03-14 - STF - Is AI in politics the final te> - § 1 reference coded [1.69% Coverage]

Reference 1 - 1.69% Coverage

Hipkins told the Star-Times that how AI was used was â€œactually really important for public confidence in democracy, because I think one of the big risks to public confidence in democracy is people not believing what they are seeing and readingâ€ .

<Files\\Processed x Highly relevant\\2025-04-07 - RNZ - The New Zealand institution he> - § 2 references coded [17.59% Coverage]

Reference 1 - 6.72% Coverage

The first thing they might notice is that Artificial Intelligence is in charge of ordering the news site.
"AI - the robots, the machines - have taken over most of The New Zealand Herald website. They have recently put off about 15 online editors, people who would assess and process and curate on that website.
"So now ... in almost all but probably about three of the top positions on the website as you're reading, you're getting served to you what a machine, or the AI algorithm, anticipates that you will read and be interested in."
If you've completed a survey telling the paper what your own particular interests are, that will be refined even further. The dominant flow of content will be tailored to you.

Reference 2 - 10.87% Coverage

"So the Herald will change per person reading it.
"I imagine their biggest [stories] they'll want to keep in position and everyone will see them, but yeah, it's going to be a slightly different experience. The argument is that it's better, that people respond more and engage more with content that they've previously wanted to see. The counter-argument is that a lot of people will be served up material they have clicked on but it might be a crash on the motorway, bad weather, celebrity news from here or overseas, court cases that are particularly gruesome or alluring ... that kind of thing.
"So it might not be as important, if you are judging that, but it's something that you have clicked on or flicked on, and it will come back to you. So it just starts to be a different experience soon. It's deliberate by NZME, they've set it in their financial reports to the market, this is what they're working on to, in their view, get more people reading more of the content they put there."
The downside of this is that it risks exactly what Facebook is criticised for, building little 'echo-boxes' for people who only see things they've seen in the past.